NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

KEY TOPIC 3 CHRONOLOGICAL ENQUIRY SEQUENCE • 1933–1939

Key Topic 3: Nazi Control and Dictatorship, 1933–39

Creation of Dictatorship, Police State, Church Relations, Propaganda & Opposition



HISTORICAL PRIMARY RECORD • SEPTEMBER 1934

The Nuremberg Party Rally: Mass Assembly of SA and SS at the Zeppelinfield

Cathedral of Light illuminated by 152 searchlights at Nuremberg, orchestrating totalitarian conformity under the Ministry of Propaganda. Accession Shelfmark BA 183-1987-0703-507.

PEARSON EDEXCEL OPTION 31 • KEY TOPIC 3 CONTENT — OFFICIAL SPECIFICATION DIRECTORY

1 The Creation of a Dictatorship, 1933–34

- The **Reichstag Fire**. The **Enabling Act** and the banning of other parties and trade unions.
- The threat from Röhm and the SA, the **Night of the Long Knives**. The death of Hindenburg. Hitler becomes Führer, the army oath of allegiance.

2 The Police State

- The role of the **Gestapo**, the **SS** and concentration camps.
- Nazi control of the legal system.

3 Controlling and Influencing Attitudes

- Goebbels and the Ministry of Propaganda: censorship, Nazi use of media, rallies and sport, including the Berlin Olympics (1936).
- Nazi control of culture and the arts, including art, architecture, literature and film.
- Nazi attempts to control the Catholic and Protestant Churches: the Concordat and the Reich Church.

4 Opposition, Resistance and Conformity

- The extent of support for the Nazi regime.
- Opposition from the Churches, including the role of Pastor Niemöller.
- Opposition from the young, including the Swing Youth and the Edelweiss Pirates.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 1: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 3)

Instructions: As you study each enquiry lesson, complete the timeline missions by sketching and annotating in the corresponding dual-coding sketchpads below.

27 FEB 1933 • The Reichstag Fire & Emergency Powers Decree

KEY TOPIC 3.1

The Reichstag building in Berlin is destroyed by arson; Dutch Communist Marinus van der Lubbe is arrested. Hitler uses the fire to persuade Hindenburg to sign the Reichstag Fire Decree, suspending freedom of speech, assembly, and press.

23 MAR 1933 • Passage of the Enabling Act (Dictatorship Established)

KEY TOPIC 3.1

Surrounded by armed SS and SA stormtroopers chanting intimidation at the Kroll Opera House, the Reichstag votes 444 to 94 to pass the Enabling Act. Hitler gains total legal power to enact laws without parliament or president for four years.

30 JUN 1934 • The Night of the Long Knives (SA Purge)

KEY TOPIC 3.1

Fearing the 2-million-strong SA under Ernst Röhm wanted a "second revolution", Hitler unleashes SS execution squads. Over 400 political rivals, including Röhm, Gregor Strasser, and former Chancellor Schleicher, are murdered without trial.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 2: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 3)

Instructions: Complete the dual-coding sketches to permanently anchor these chronological turning points in long-term memory.

2 AUG 1934 • Death of Hindenburg & The Armed Forces Oath

KEY TOPIC 3.1

President Hindenburg dies aged 86. Hitler merges the offices of Chancellor and President, assuming the supreme title of Führer und Reichskanzler. Every officer and soldier in the German armed forces swears an unconditional oath of loyalty to Hitler personally.

JUL 1933 • The Reich Concordat with the Vatican

KEY TOPIC 3.2

Hitler signs an agreement with Pope Pius XI: the Catholic Church promises to stay out of German politics, while the Nazi regime guarantees religious freedom and Catholic schools. Within months, the Nazis begin systematically harassing Catholic youth groups and priests.

AUG 1936 • The Berlin Olympic Games Propaganda Showcase

KEY TOPIC 3.3

Germany hosts the 11th Olympic Games in Berlin, showcasing Nazi modern efficiency to 49 nations. Anti-Semitic signs are temporarily removed, but African-American sprinter Jesse Owens demolishes Aryan racial theories by winning four gold medals.

How did the Nazi regime eliminate all legal and political opposition between January 1933 and August 1934?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • How was the arson used as a pretext to destroy constitutional rights?

- Reichstag Fire (Feb 1933)
- Marinus van der Lubbe
- Communist plot allegation

2 • Why did the Enabling Act effectively end parliamentary democracy in Germany?

- Reichstag Fire Decree
- Habeas corpus suspended
- Mass Communist arrests

3 • How did Gleichschaltung dismantle independent social and political bodies?

- 1933 Enabling Act
- Kroll Opera House vote
- Reichstag powers surrendered

4 • Why did the Führer purge his own paramilitary commanders?

- Night of Long Knives
- Ernst Röhm executed
- SA paramilitary purged

5 • How did the military oath cement total control over the armed forces?

- President Hindenburg dies
- Führer and Chancellor combined
- Armed forces loyalty oath

"Enabling Act 23 March 1933: Passed by SA intimidation, ending parliamentary democracy in Germany."

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why the Nazi regime was able to establish a one-party dictatorship by August 1934. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer: • The Reichstag Fire (February 1933) • The Night of the Long Knives (June 1934) *(You must also use information of your own.)*

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Therefore, this led to... • Another key factor was... • Consequently, this meant that...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 6)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 3.1). In the drawing box, sketch the burning Reichstag building alongside the SA badge of Ernst Röhm crossed out in red. Annotate how Hitler eliminated both external enemies and internal rivals. [ ] Done

Continue your response below (complete Factor 3 from own knowledge & concluding analytical verdict):

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE A** 4 MARKS • 5 MINS Score: [/ 4]

Give two things you can infer from Source A about the effect of the Reichstag Fire Decree on German political life.

SOURCE A *From the diary of an anti-Nazi German schoolteacher, Berlin, 1 March 1933.*

"A terrible pall of fear has fallen over the city since the fire. Last night, plainclothes police and armed SA broke into my neighbour's flat and dragged his son away without explanation. The telephone lines are tapped; newspapers carrying the slightest criticism are shut down. We speak only in whispers."

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

How effectively did the SS, Gestapo, courts, and religious policies terrorise and control the German population?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • How did the SS evolve into the regime's ideological army and camp master?

- Heinrich Himmler SS
- Schutzstaffel blackshirts
- SD intelligence security

2 • Why did ordinary civilian denunciations make the secret police seem omnipresent?

- Gestapo secret police
- Dachau concentration camp (1933)
- Indefinite protective custody

3 • How did the abolition of independent courts undermine the rule of law?

- National Socialist League Jurists
- People's Court (Roland Freisler)
- Judicial independence abolished

4 • Why did the regime violate the Concordat and persecute Catholic youth groups?

- Reichskonkordat treaty (1933)
- Catholic Church autonomy promised
- Center Party dissolved

5 • Why did the creation of the Reich Church spark theological rebellion?

- Protestant Reich Church
- Martin Niemöller opposition
- Confessional Church resistance

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why the Nazi police state and control over the churches was effective in the years 1933–1939. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer:	• The role of the Gestapo and SS	• The Concordat with the Catholic Church (1933)	***(You must also use information of your own.)***

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Therefore, this led to... • Another key factor was... • Consequently, this meant that...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 9)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 3.2). In the drawing box, sketch a Gestapo interrogation file alongside a swastika placed on a church altar. Annotate how the regime combined secret terror with control over spiritual life. [ ] Done

"Death of Hindenburg Aug 1934: Hitler merged Chancellor and President into the supreme title of Führer."

Continue your response below (complete Factor 3 from own knowledge & concluding analytical verdict):

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE B** 4 MARKS • 5 MINS Score: [/ 4]

Give two things you can infer from Source B about public fear of the Gestapo in Nazi Germany.

SOURCE B *From an interview with a German factory worker who lived in Essen during the 1930s.*

"You never knew who was listening. The man at the next workbench might be a party block warden, or the woman sweeping the hallway might report you for not giving the Hitler salute. People vanished overnight into protective custody. You learned to keep your head down and look straight ahead."

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE B that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE B that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

How did Joseph Goebbels use censorship, mass media, spectacle, and cultural control to indoctrinate the German people?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • How did the Ministry enforce strict ideological conformity across all media?

- Reich Ministry of Propaganda
- Joseph Goebbels control
- Total media censorship

2 • Why was the affordable People's Receiver the most powerful propaganda tool?

- Volksempfänger cheap radio
- 70% household radio ownership
- Foreign broadcast bans

3 • How did choreographed mass rallies overwhelm individual critical thought?

- Annual Nuremberg Rallies
- Zeppelin Field cathedral of light
- Leni Riefenstahl propaganda films

4 • Why were the 1936 Olympics staged as an international showcase of Nazi success?

- Berlin Olympics (1936)
- Nazi athletic showcase
- Jesse Owens track victories

5 • Why did the regime denounce modern artistic expression as degenerate?

- 1933 Book burnings
- 'Degenerate Art' ban
- Albert Speer neoclassical architecture

"The SS & Gestapo: Himmler's blackshirts and plainclothes terror silenced all public dissent."

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why the Nazi regime was able to control and influence attitudes in Germany in the years 1933–1939. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer: • The use of radio and the Volksempfänger • Censorship of newspapers and the arts *(You must also use information of your own.)*

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Therefore, this led to... • Another key factor was... • Consequently, this meant that...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 12)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 3.3). In the drawing box, sketch a Volksempfänger radio broadcasting Hitler's voice alongside the searchlights of the Nuremberg Cathedral of Light. Annotate how propaganda saturated daily life. [ ] Done

QUESTION 2: EXPLAIN WHY CONTINUED [12 MARKS]

Continue your response below (complete Factor 3 from own knowledge & concluding analytical verdict):

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE C**

4 MARKS • 5 MINS **Score: [/ 4]**

Give two things you can infer from Source C about how Nazi propaganda was used to influence public opinion.

SOURCE C *From an account by an American reporter living in Berlin, published in 1935.*

"One cannot escape the regime's message for a single waking hour. Loudspeakers on street corners blare out political speeches, and in every cafe the cheap People's Radio plays marching songs interspersed with news bulletins praising the Führer's achievements. Even in the cinema, lights remain dimmed until the compulsory newsreel finishes, ensuring every citizen absorbs the state's triumphant version of reality."

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE C that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE C that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

"Book Burnings May 1933: Works by Freud, Marx, and Einstein torched in Berlin university squares."

Why was active opposition to the Nazi regime so limited between 1933 and 1939, and how did youth and church groups resist?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • Why did the majority of German citizens conform rather than openly resist?

• Popular Nazi conformity	
• Economic recovery approval	
• Terror police compliance	

2 • How did outlawed Communist and Socialist cells maintain clandestine resistance?

• KPD and SPD underground cells	
• Rote Kapelle courier networks	
• Factory sabotage & illegal leaflets	

3 • Why did working-class youth rebel against compulsory state youth movements?

• Edelweiss Pirates defiance	
• Working-class youth rebellion	
• Camp beatings & anti-Nazi leaflets	

4 • How did middle-class youth use foreign music to reject Nazi conformity?

• Swing Youth culture	
• American jazz music	
• Middle-class non-conformity	

5 • Why did the regime hesitate to execute high-profile church critics?

• Mit Brennender Sorge (1937)	
• Pastor Martin Niemöller & Bonhoeffer	
• Bishop von Galen euthanasia protests	

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why active opposition to the Nazi regime was limited in the years 1933–1939. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer: • The Gestapo and concentration camps • Economic recovery and Nazi social policies *(You must also use information of your own.)*

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Therefore, this led to... • Another key factor was... • Consequently, this meant that...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 15)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 3.4). In the drawing box, sketch an Edelweiss flower badge alongside illegal jazz records of the Swing Youth. Annotate why young rebels rejected regimented Hitler Youth drills. [ ] Done

Continue your response below (complete Factor 3 from own knowledge & concluding analytical verdict):

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE D** **4 MARKS • 5 MINS** **Score: [/ 4]**

Give two things you can infer from Source D about the activities and attitudes of the Edelweiss Pirates.

SOURCE D *From a confidential Gestapo report on youth opposition in the Rhineland, 1938.*

"Groups of youths between fourteen and seventeen, styling themselves the Edelweiss Pirates, continually evade state authority. They refuse to join the Hitler Youth, wear distinctive metal flower badges on their lapels, and gather secretly in parks at night singing banned songs. They openly mock party officials and have repeatedly assaulted patrol leaders in darkened streets."

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE D that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE D that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

Question 3(a): Source Utility [8 marks • 12 mins]

SOURCE B

Speech by Propaganda Minister Joseph Goebbels to Radio Directors, Berlin, March 1933

From an official address given by Dr. Joseph Goebbels to regional broadcasting directors in Berlin, March 1933, shortly after his appointment as Minister of Public Enlightenment and Propaganda.

"We make no bones about it: the radio belongs to us and to no one else! We will place radio in the service of our National Socialist idea, and no other idea shall be expressed here. Radio must be purged of all un-German elements. We intend to mobilize the minds of the entire nation so thoroughly that no foreign or hostile thought can find an audience."

SOURCE C

Contemporary photograph of the People's Radio (Volksempfänger VE301), Berlin, 1933



From an official photograph published in Germany, 1933. It shows the newly introduced Volksempfänger (People's Radio), commissioned by Joseph Goebbels.

The Volksempfänger was mass-produced to sell for only 76 Reichsmarks, roughly one week's wage for an average industrial worker. By 1939, over seventy percent of German households owned a radio set—the highest proportion in Europe. The sets were engineered with a limited shortwave receiver so that ordinary citizens could not easily listen to foreign broadcasts, ensuring that families heard only Nazi propaganda and Hitler's speeches.

Study Sources B and C. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into Nazi methods of controlling and influencing attitudes in the years 1933–1939? [8 marks]

Assessment Formula: Evaluate Content + Provenance (Author, Motive, Date) with contextual knowledge for Source B, then Source C.

Evaluate Source B (Content & Provenance on state monopoly of broadcasting and totalitarian propaganda goals): *(Source C evaluation continues on Page 17)*

QUESTION 3(A) CONTINUED: EVALUATE SOURCE C (CONTENT & PROVENANCE ON CHEAP RADIO SETS, MASS DOMESTIC LISTENING, AND FOREIGN CENSORSHIP):

Score: [/ 8]

HISTORICAL INTERPRETATIONS 1 AND 2

Target: How and why historians differ (AO4)

INTERPRETATION 1

From an account by historian David Welch, The Third Reich: Politics and Propaganda (2002)

"Nazi propaganda was remarkably successful in winning over the hearts and minds of the German people. Joseph Goebbels understood that propaganda could not rely solely on crude slogans; it had to appeal to existing national traditions and pride. Through the distribution of cheap 'People's Radios', the cinematic spectacles of Leni Riefenstahl, and the euphoric pageantry of the Nuremberg rallies, the regime created a genuine sense of national community (Volksgemeinschaft). For the majority of Germans between 1933 and 1939, conformity was based on genuine enthusiasm and admiration for Hitler rather than state coercion."

INTERPRETATION 2

From an account by historian Richard J. Evans, The Third Reich in Power (2005)

"The apparent unity of the German people was fundamentally an illusion created by the omnipresence of the terror state. While Goebbels' propaganda was loud and relentless, ordinary Germans were far more cynical and detached than official rallies suggested. What truly controlled attitudes was the constant threat of denunciation to the Gestapo, the pervasive network of SS surveillance, and the dread of protective custody in concentration camps like Dachau. Germans did not conform because they believed every word broadcast on the radio; they conformed because speaking out meant arrest, torture, and ruin."

Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about Nazi methods of controlling and influencing attitudes in the years 1933–1939. What is the main difference between these views? [4 marks]

Score: [/ 4]

Mark Scheme Law: Identify the fundamental difference in emphasis, then back up each view with direct quotes or specific details from both interpretations.

Question 3(c): Why Views Differ [4 marks • 5 mins]

Score: [/ 4]

Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about Nazi methods of controlling and influencing attitudes in the years 1933–1939. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer. [4 marks]

Examiner Guidance: AO4 [4 marks]: Explain differing emphasis on media reach and popular culture (Sources B & C) vs police archives and judicial repression.

QUESTION 3(D) ESSAY PLANNING & CRITERIA SETUP

16 Marks + 4 SPaG = 20 Marks • 25 Mins

How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about Nazi methods of controlling and influencing attitudes in the years 1933–1939? Explain your answer, using both interpretations and your knowledge of the historical context. [16 marks + 4 SPaG]

Thesis Prompt: Formulate your sustained thesis: Did the Nazi regime control and influence German attitudes primarily through the persuasive power of propaganda and mass media, or through fear of the police state and Gestapo terror?

Criteria Planning Canvas: Establish criteria benchmark, map quotes from Int 1 & Int 2, and outline your verdict:

(Essay continues on Page 19)

Level 4 Target (13–16 Marks): Balanced analysis of both views • Sustained contextual knowledge • Justified criteria-led judgment.

SPaG: 4/4 MARKS

Question 3(d): Evaluative Essay on Historical Interpretations

AO4: [/ 16] | SPaG: [/ 4] | Total: [/ 20]

[16 MARKS + 4 SPAG = 20 MARKS • TIMED ESSAY: 25 MINS]

How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about Nazi methods of controlling and influencing attitudes in the years 1933–1939? Explain your answer, using both interpretations and your knowledge of the historical context. [16 marks + 4 SPaG]

Write your response in the space provided below:

Band 4 Criteria Check:	[ ] Criteria Established	[ ] Both Ints Explored	[ ] Precise Own Knowledge	[ ] Justified Verdict	**Teacher Sign-off:** _____

"Question 3(d): Build a criteria-led argument evaluating whether church dissent constituted genuine resistance." **19/20**

STUDENT ASSESSMENT RECORD • KEY TOPIC 3 TRACKER

Paper 3: Weimar and Nazi Germany, 1918–1939 (Nazi Control and Dictatorship, 1933–39)

PUPIL: _____ **TARGET GRADE:** ☐ **PREDICTED:** ☐ **ATTITUDE:** 1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5

#	ENQUIRY / ASSESSMENT UNIT	DO NOW (10M)	Q1 INFER (4M)	Q2 EXPLAIN (12M)	MODULE TOTAL
1	**KT3.1: The Creation of a Dictatorship, 1933–1934** *"How did the Nazi regime eliminate all legal and political opposition between January 1933 and August 1934?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
2	**KT3.2: The Police State and Religious Control** *"How effectively did the SS, Gestapo, courts, and religious policies terrorise and control the German population?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
3	**KT3.3: Controlling and Influencing Attitudes** *"How did Joseph Goebbels use censorship, mass media, spectacle, and cultural control to indoctrinate the German people?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
4	**KT3.4: Opposition, Resistance and Conformity** *"Why was active opposition to the Nazi regime so limited between 1933 and 1939, and how did youth and church groups resist?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
★	**Section B Capstone Assessment (pp. 16–19)** *Q3(a) Utility [8m] • Q3(b) Study Views [4m] • Q3(c) Why Differ [4m] • Q3(d) Evaluative Essay [20m]*	Q3(a): / 8	Q3(b): / 4	Q3(c): / 4 • Q3(d): / 20	/ 36
KEY TOPIC 3 CUMULATIVE ASSESSMENT TOTALS		**Do Now: / 40**	**Q1 Infer: / 16**	**Q2 Cause: / 48**	**/ 140**

TEACHER FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT • WWW / EBI FEEDBACK

WHAT WENT WELL (WWW):

_____

_____

_____

EVEN BETTER IF (EBI):

_____

_____

_____

Teacher Signature: _____ **Date:** _____

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KT 3.1	KT 3.2	KT 3.3	KT 3.4
SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ
Score: / 20	**Score: / 20**	**Score: / 20**	**Score: / 20**